PRINTABLE

QoS / DSCP cheat sheet

Marks

- EF 46: voice media. Priority queue. RFC 3246 and RFC 4594 telephony.
- AF41 34: interactive video. AF42 is 36, AF43 is 38 (higher drop).
- CS3 24: call signaling on many Cisco designs.
- CS5 40: signaling in RFC 4594. That RFC gives CS3 to broadcast video.
- AF31 26: streaming video in RFC 4594.
- CS6 48: network control. CS1 8: low priority. DF 0: best effort.

Do not skip

A mark is not a queue. Trust the phone, not an untrusted PC port. Re-mark at the boundary if one side uses CS3 and the other uses CS5. Do not mark signaling as EF.

Bandwidth sketch

20 ms Ethernet planning, headers included: G.711 about 87 kbit/s; G.729 about 31 kbit/s. Payload rates are 64 and 8. Cap the priority queue so EF cannot fill the link.

Field names

DSCP is six bits (RFC 2474). The other two bits are ECN (RFC 3168). 802.1p CoS is a different three-bit field. CoS 5 is often the voice map, and it is not the same as DSCP 46 until a policy says so.

UC Lab field card · fictional examples only · confirm RFCs and current vendor docs before production changes.

Sources and go deeper

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Opened 2026-10. A row marked confirm has no link, because that page was not verified.
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